



BRIGHTON REAL ALE SOCIETY

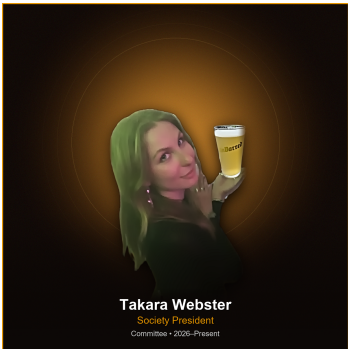
Executive Handover & Website Operations Guide

A Comprehensive Manual for Live Pub Socials, Digital Scoring, and Society Administration

OFFICIAL NOTICE — WORK IN PROGRESS (WIP) EDITION:

This handbook represents the complete live operational standard for the Brighton Real Ale Society web platform (<https://www.brightonale.co.uk>). The system is fully operational for live socials, voting, leaderboard tracking, and administrative controls. While minor visual polish, seasonal archives, and additional features remain under active development, all procedures documented herein reflect active, production-ready capabilities.

Target Audience:	Takara Webster (Society President) Harrison Emrys-Jones (Finance Director)
Prepared By:	Harry Rogers (VP & IT Officer, 2025–2026) Max Emery (Socials & Media Officer, 2024–2026)
Outgoing & Founding Officers:	Albie Gullis (President, 2025–2026) James Graham (Founding President, 2023–2025)
Active Executive Roster:	Rico Chadwick Gugolz (VP Social, 2026–Present)
Date of Issue:	September 2026 • Term 2026/2027
Platform & Domain:	https://www.brightonale.co.uk (Vercel Edge / Next.js 16 / Supabase)



Takara Webster
Society President



Harrison Emrys-Jones
Finance Director

1. Executive Welcome & Transition Charter

Welcome, Takara and Harrison! As the incoming executive leadership of the Brighton Real Ale Society for the 2026/2027 term and beyond, you inherit a rich, vibrant tradition spanning four years of cask ale exploration, over 800 member ratings, and deep ties with Brighton's historic pubs.

This platform is custom-built to support your weekly socials, eliminate friction for members, and maintain an accurate historical archive that publicans and tasters take pride in. Everything is designed to be easily operated from a smartphone right at the pub table.

Executive Division of Responsibilities

Role	Officer	Primary Responsibilities & Website Duties
President	Takara Webster	- Overall society leadership and pub liaison. - Selection of weekly host pubs and liaison with cellar managers. - Chairing committee meetings and sanctioning official society announcements. - Activating the official pint of the night in /committee.
Finance Director	Harrison Emrys-Jones	- Society bank account management and treasury tracking. - Monitoring membership subscriptions and pub expenditure receipts. - Exporting the Member Matrix CSV for financial and attendance auditing. - Oversight of annual awards trophies and merchandise budgets.
VP Social	Rico Chadwick Gugolz	- Social schedule promotion and attendee engagement. - Encouraging member turnout and ensuring all attendees submit their live scores. - Social photography and Instagram recap curation.
IT & Systems (Advisory)	Harry Rogers	- Technical stewardship, Supabase PostgreSQL database maintenance, and code builds. - Domain DNS (brightonale.co.uk) and Next.js hosting.

2. Society Philosophy & CAMRA Alignment

The Brighton Real Ale Society stands in active alignment with the **Campaign for Real Ale (CAMRA)**, the world's foremost consumer campaign founded in 1971. Every rating entered into our platform is an evaluation of traditional cask-conditioned ale.

The Three Pillars of Cask Conditioned Beer

- 1. Living Yeast:** Secondary fermentation occurs naturally inside the cask in the pub cellar, evolving flavour and mouthfeel.
- 2. Unpasteurized & Unfiltered:** Crucial hop oils and delicate malt profiles are preserved entirely without thermal damage.
- 3. Natural Carbonation:** Served without extraneous gas cylinders (CO2 or nitrogen); gentle, natural effervescence.

The National Beer Scoring System (NBSS) Calibration

To ensure objectivity across all tasters, our 10.0-point scoring scale is formally calibrated against CAMRA's established 0 to 5 condition scale:

CAMRA NBSS	Condition Descriptor	BRAS Scale	Tasting Assessment Criteria
5.0	Perfect	8.5 – 10.0★	Sublime cask condition. Peak clarity, ideal cellar temperature (11-13°C), vibrant aroma, immaculate carbonation. Zero faults.
4.0	Very Good	7.0 – 8.4★	Excellent pint. Served fresh, well-conditioned, clean head retention, true to brewery style.

3.0	Good	6.0 – 6.9★	Sound commercial standard. Completely enjoyable, satisfactory temperature and mouthfeel, minor loss of aroma.
2.0	Average	4.5 – 5.9★	Drinkable but unimpressive. Lacks vitality, slightly warm or flat, muted hop presence.
1.0	Poor	3.0 – 4.4★	Definite cellar faults. Stale, unpleasantly warm, souring, hazy without reason, or oxidized.
0.0	Undrinkable	1.0 – 2.9★	Vinegar, infected, returned to the bar immediately.

Official CAMRA National Beer Scoring Guide

How's your beer?		
Rating	Description	Your reaction
Excellent	Exceptional and clear (if intended to be) with fantastic aromas, flavours and ideal carbonation.	Superb! You tell your friends and compliment the cellar manager.
Very good	Satisfying and well-kept with a great appearance, good carbonation and enticing aromas and flavours.	You consider having another and may cancel plans to move to another pub.
Good	Nice appearance, good carbonation, aromas and flavour.	Pleasant but not memorable. You're happy to have another but might consider something else.
Acceptable	Unremarkable and ordinary, with no noteworthy characteristics.	You're unlikely to have another unless it is all there is and there isn't another pub to go to.
Poor	Noticeably imperfect.	Drinkable with resentment, but you politely ask for a replacement.
Undrinkable	Unpleasant to drink, likely with a disgusting taste, incorrect appearance and off/foul aroma.	You politely ask for it to be replaced and consider asking the publican to take it off.

Official graphic © Campaign for Real Ale (CAMRA). Reproduced for educational and scoring calibration purposes. Visit <https://camra.org.uk/beer-and-pubs/beer/beer-scoring/>.

3. Live Social Scoring Workflow (`/rate`)

The live rating page is the lifeblood of our weekly socials. We intentionally removed passwords for voters: any attendee who scans the QR code or opens <https://www.brightonale.co.uk/rate> can score within 5 seconds.

How Attendee Scoring Operates

Step 1: Arrive & Open Rate Page. Attendees open `/rate` on their smartphone browser.

Step 2: Enter Name. On their first social, the member types their name (e.g. *Takara W.*). The site permanently stores this in local cookies so they never have to type it again.

Step 3: Select Rating. Quick buttons allow one-tap selection (5.0, 6.0, 7.0, 7.5, 8.0, 8.5, 9.0), or the slider allows precise decimal scores (e.g. 8.25★).

Step 4: Tap Submit Rating. Instant submission records the score to the database and displays a green confirmation message.

CRITICAL VOTING FEATURES & SAFEGUARDS:

- **In-Place Deduplication:** If an attendee re-rates the same pint (e.g. they decide a pint warmed up or improved), their previous score is smoothly updated in place. It will NEVER create duplicate rows or distort the society average.
- **Returning Voter Recognition:** Returning members are immediately greeted with their name and their existing vote if cast.
- **Idle State Protection:** If the committee has not set an active pint, the page displays a polite 'No Active Pint Set' notice, preventing erroneous scores from being submitted out-of-round.

4. The Committee Command Center (`/committee`)

The committee dashboard at `/committee` is your administrative headquarters. From here, Takara or Harrison can start a round, monitor incoming votes live, remove bad entries, manage historical events, and configure site features.

Standard Pub Night Operational Checklist

Phase	Action	Dashboard Control / Procedure
1. Arrival	Sign in as Committee	Navigate to <code>/committee</code> . Log in with the committee account credentials. Session persists via secure cookie.
2. Round Start	Activate Tonight's Pint	Under ' Active Pint for Scoring ', select the Pub (e.g. <i>The Hole in the Wall</i>), enter the Cask Ale (e.g. <i>Harvey's Sussex Best</i>), Brewery, and confirm the date. Tap ' Activate Pint for Scoring '.
3. In-Social	Monitor Live Voting	Watch the ' Active Pint Live Votes ' monitor. Inspect real-time vote count, running average score, and each attendee's submitted rating. The counter refreshes automatically.
4. Moderation	Discard Erroneous Votes	If someone accidentally submits a typo (e.g. a joke 1.0 or test vote), tap ' Remove ' next to their vote. <i>Note: This is strictly scoped to the active social; historical archives are completely safe.</i>
5. Wrap-Up	Conclude Scoring	When leaving the pub, tap ' Stop Scoring '. The social and its final average score are immediately locked and permanently committed to the Society Matrix & Leaderboards.

Additional Committee Controls

- **Add Past Socials:** Use the 'Add Past Social / Historical Event' card to log past pub visits, photos, and ratings.
- **Feature Toggles:** Instantly enable or disable public visibility of Leaderboard, Matrix, Wordle, Awards, or Gallery with one tap.
- **Daily Ale Wordle:** Set the daily 5-letter brewing or ale word and hint for member entertainment.

- **Photo Gallery:** Upload and categorize photos from past pub crawls into dedicated social albums.

5. Intelligence & Data Archives

BRAS maintains one of the most comprehensive student real ale databases in the UK. Understanding where this data lives and how to extract it is essential for society reporting.

The Member × Pub Matrix (`/matrix`)

The Matrix tabulates every single pint rating submitted by BRAS inspectors across every pub visited since 2023. It features live search by member name or pub, color-coded score cells (green for sublime, yellow for solid, orange/red for poor), and individual inspector analytics (most generous taster, harshest critic, attendance counts).

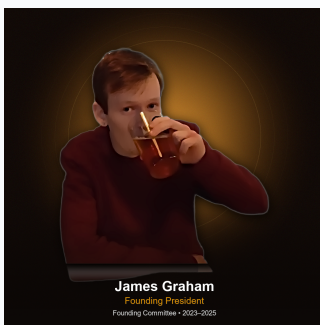
Exporting CSVs for Harrison: At the top right of the matrix page, tap **'Export CSV'**. This generates a complete, spreadsheet-compatible .csv file containing every member's attendance and score. Harrison can open this directly in Microsoft Excel or Google Sheets for attendance tracking, term reports, and dues verification.

Society Leaderboards (`/leaderboard`)

Displays real-time rankings across three categories: **Top Rated Ales** (highest average pint scores), **Top Ranked Pubs** (best kept cellars), and **Top Brewers** (Sussex & UK independent breweries). Minimum rating thresholds prevent single-vote anomalies.

Society History & Directory (`/history`)

Chronological timeline of every Instagram post and official social recap from our inaugural meeting at The Hole in the Wall in 2023 to the present day. Includes the official Committee Directory cards on the heritage tavern background.



Founding Legacy: James Graham

Founding President (2023–2025). James established the society's culture of camaraderie, cellar appreciation, and objective scoring that Takara and Harrison now steward into the 2026/2027 term. The new official portrait card is now permanently archived in the digital directory.

6. Executive & Financial Protocols

Special Guidance for Takara Webster (President)

- **Host Pub Protocol:** Ensure the cellar manager or licensee knows BRAS is visiting. Many independent pubs offer real ale discounts or cellar tours for society members.
- **Opening the Social:** At the start of the night, announce the official pint of the round and remind everyone to open brightonale.co.uk/rate.
- **New Member Welcomes:** Make sure newcomers pair up with a committee member to learn the CAMRA scoring standard.
- **Constitutional Custody:** Coordinate committee election schedules and AGM recaps at the conclusion of the academic year.

Special Guidance for Harrison Emrys-Jones (Finance Director)

- **Membership Dues:** Cross-reference newly registered voter names on the Matrix with paid society subscriptions.
- **Pub Spend Records:** Keep receipts for any subsidized rounds, society tab contributions, or awards purchases.
- **Quarterly Audit:** Use the Matrix CSV export to audit turnouts and provide an annual financial statement.
- **Annual Awards Budget:** Allocate funds in Term 2 for the official engraved pint glasses and tankards presented at the Annual Awards Social.

7. Technical & Maintenance Quick Reference

For Harry and any future technical stewards, here is the essential cheat-sheet for managing the codebase, database, and deployments:

Item / Task	Standard Procedure & Command Line
Repository	GitHub: https://github.com/brightonale/bras-website.git (Branch: main)
Production Build	MANDATORY FLAG: Always run <code>npx next build --webpack</code> . Never run without <code>--webpack</code> .
Development Server	Run <code>npm run dev</code> . Server starts on <code>http://localhost:3000</code> .
Database Migrations	PostgreSQL on Supabase. Run <code>npx prisma db push</code> to sync schema changes. Connection pooler uses PgBouncer on port 6543.
Domain & DNS	Primary: https://www.brightonale.co.uk (Redirect: brightonale.co.uk). Hosted on Vercel Edge.
Portrait Generation	Run <code>python scripts/enhance-and-composite-all.py</code> to regenerate committee portrait cards on <code>bg_heritage_tavern</code> .

A FINAL NOTE FROM THE OUTGOING COMMITTEE:

To Takara, Harrison, and Rico: The society is in tremendous hands. Treat every publican with warmth, demand excellence in the glass, never settle for flat keg lager, and keep Brighton's cask heritage thriving. Cheers to a fantastic 2026/2027 term!